



WITH A POPULATION OF 1.28 BILLION, China has the largest

CHINESE

THE WORLD'S OLDEST CIVILIZATION

population of any country on Earth.

One person in five in the world is Chinese. The country also has the world's oldest continuous civilization,



FARMING

Even though there are a lot of cities in China, nearly three-quarters of the population live in the countryside and farm the land, of which only about 10 per cent is fertile. The main crops are rice, wheat, and millet.

City living

For many years the communist Chinese government had control of all industry. However, since the 1980s the government has given greater freedom to people starting businesses and encouraged international trade. As a result, the cities have gone through an economic boom, with the industry starting to draw in millions of workers from the countryside. Modern architecture stands alongside ancient buildings.

CHINESE NEW YEAR

Chinese New Year is the first day of the first month in the lunar calendar. Festivities go on every day until the 15th day, which is the Lantern Festival, when people decorate their homes with beautiful, richly colored lanterns.



TRADITIONAL CULTURE

Old ways of life are still very much evident in China, and some have even spread throughout the world. Chinese herbal medicine and the ancient art of acupuncture are now commonly used worldwide, and Chinese food is popular in many countries, brought in by immigrant Chinese communities.

TAI CHI

Many Chinese people practice Tai Chi, which is a martial art that can also be performed slowly and used to decrease stress and maintain physical health. Every morning, in parks all over China, people can be seen practicing Tai Chi forms.

